

A full-page photograph of Roger Federer in mid-air during a tennis serve. He is wearing a white headband, a white short-sleeved polo shirt with a small red logo on the chest, and white shorts with a red logo on the left leg. His arms are extended horizontally, and his legs are spread wide in a powerful leap. The background is a blurred crowd of spectators in a stadium.

Maestro moves: Roger Federer was renowned for turning his head on groundstrokes as the ball came within a yard of his contact point so that his eyes stayed focused on the ball through the contact point. He also kept his head still, further aiding his sighting. As a result, the 20-time Major champion timed the ball exceedingly well and could adjust quickly to any abrupt or unpredictable late changes in the flight of the ball. PICS: GETTY IMAGES



In addition to their superb athleticism, elite coaching, and intensive practice, world-class tennis players understand the keys to great timing.